

APAC Credit Roundup

APAC Cross Regional Credit Weekly, US Credit, Pakistan, OCBC, Zhongsheng, UPL

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APAC Cross Regional Credit Weekly - Spreads near cycle tight; expect supportive technicals to cushion heavy supply

JULI spreads tightened by 2bp to 89bp over the week. The index yield edged down 4bp w/w to 5.44%. Technicals are solid, with large fund inflows, strong reinvestment flows, and improving foreign demand well positioned to absorb a near-term supply surge. HG fund flows saw a broad-based surge to \$12.8bn (+246% w/w) last week, the largest inflow since the first week of February and the fifth-largest on record. Last week, \$35bn of issuance was priced against just \$17bn of reinvestment income, while maturity and coupon flows jump to \$51bn this week, 75% above the 2026 weekly average. Foreign demand metrics continue to improve, as markets are still pricing in a 75% chance of a rate hike from both the ECB and the BoJ in June. Turning to fundamentals, earnings are strong and positive for HG credit. Our US team highlights that companies with more debt are growing earnings faster than the average, so higher coupons alone are unlikely to force deleveraging. The team expects spreads to remain tight despite heavy issuance, as fundamentals are keeping pace with higher debt levels.

On the macro side, the April jobs report points to a stable labor market. Payrolls increased 115k with the unemployment rate holding stable at 4.3%. Combined with other indicators such as jobless claims, the labor market is showing signs of moving past last year's weakness. Fed rhetoric has turned more hawkish as well, and the latest jobs gains should reinforce the sense that the next rate move could be either up or down. Given that core inflation has also moved further away from the 2% target, overall, our rates team thinks these developments support their view that the money market curve can steepen further over the second half of 2026, and they continue to forecast 5- and 10-year Treasury yields will rise to 4.25% and 4.5% by YE26, respectively. Additionally, for this week's CPI, our economists forecast that headline CPI rose 0.51% m/m (3.6% oya) in April, with the core increasing 0.36% (2.7% oya). For more details, please see [APAC Cross Regional Credit Weekly](#).

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For key risks and catalysts not already described in this report, please refer to the most recent [Emerging Markets Corporate Coverage Report](#).

See page 6 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

(Matt/Emma)

US Credit - Introducing Hyperscaler Bond Matrix Version 1.0

Our US colleagues published [AI Capex Funding: Data Center - Hyperscaler Bond Matrix Version 1.0](#), mapping out the growing universe of data center financing. The combined hyperscaler and data center universe across the high grade and high yield indices encompasses 27 different issuers with over US\$450 billion of bonds outstanding. The interrelationships between hyperscalers and the various data center projects they lease create an investable universe of effectively related obligations at different risk profiles. The average relationship between a hyperscaler's bonds and the bonds of IG-rated and HY-rated projects for which it is the lessor is 105bp and 183bp, respectively. Within HY, the relationships appear to be driven less by ratings and more by how advanced the particular projects are from a construction standpoint. Our colleagues introduced High Performance Computing sub-indices across both High Grade and High Yield. The new Data Center sub-sector within JULI will initially contain all 4 data center bonds issued to date. The index is currently US\$49bn par, representing 4.8% of its parent sector Technology and 0.5% of the overall JULI. Notably, the HPC sector in the High Yield Index has grown to 2.68% of the market. (Emma)

Pakistan - IMF Board approval of EFF and inaugural panda bond issuance

The IMF Board approved on Friday the third review of the ongoing arrangement with Pakistan under the Extended Fund Facility (EFF) as well as the second review of the arrangement under the Resilience and Sustainability Fund (RSF). The approval will unlock a US\$1.3bn disbursement to Pakistan in the coming days. The IMF's press release was relatively high level, offering little new information on the policy path ahead while broadly commending the authorities' policy response and crisis management efforts. However, several aspects of the IMF's updated projections are worth highlighting. First, the Fund has maintained the **primary surplus targets** unchanged at 2.5% of GDP for the current FY2025/26, and 2% of GDP for FY2026/27, signaling continued confidence in the government's commitment to adjustment policies despite Pakistan being one of the most exposed countries to the global energy shock, as previously discussed by our economists ([note](#)). However, the **composition of the fiscal adjustment** is now more heavily skewed towards larger spending cuts, with budget revenue/GDP, a key weakness for Pakistan's sovereign credit profile, revised lower relative to the projections embedded in the second EFF review, suggesting continued underperformance against tax mobilization targets (December 2025). Moreover, the IMF has significantly lowered its **gross FX reserves** projections, reducing them by US\$2.4bn for June 2027. This aligns with our economists' expectation that the Fund will show flexibility in terms of reserve accumulation targets provided that the authorities continue to implement appropriate policies in response to the global shock ([note](#)). Lastly, the IMF has raised its **inflation** projection for June 2026 to 11.5% from 8.9% previously, while expecting it to return to the central bank's target range in June 2027, suggesting the Fund views the current shock's impact on Pakistan's price dynamics to be transitory. (Mahmoud)

Separately, Pakistan has [reportedly](#) received regulatory approval for its delayed panda bond, and could proceed with its inaugural RMB-denominated issuance on China's onshore market in the next few days, potentially raising the equivalent of US\$250mn as part of a planned US\$1 billion programme ([link](#)). The multilaterally-guaranteed issuance forms part of the financing program underpinning the ongoing IMF arrangement. It will add to the US\$3bn in fresh Saudi financing and a US\$750mn Eurobond issuance in April to help cover additional financing needs from an unexpected US\$3.5bn deposit repayment to the UAE, and a widening current account deficit which our economists project at 1.1% of GDP in FY2025/26 due to the impact of the global energy shock. The Pakistani government plans to diversify its

financing sources as it achieves progress on reforms under its ongoing IMF arrangement, and is contemplating a range of commercial instruments, including global dollar-settled, rupee-linked notes and sukuk ([note](#)).

OCBC – Initiate with OW on the 2036 / '31c bonds

Similar to its Singapore peers, OCBC's (bond ticker: OCBCSP) first quarter update contained little that should concern credit investors, despite the uncertain backdrop. While net interest margin was under pressure, non-interest income offset this and, importantly, the balance sheet remains strong. Stability in operating trends allow us to focus on relative value, which we find compelling for Singapore bank subordinated bonds. We initiate on OCBCSP's on-the-run 2036 / '31c subordinated bond with an Overweight rating. Offered at z+105bp (SOT+78bp, \$98.5, 4.9%), the spread is a few bp wider than for the slightly shorter-dated subordinated bonds with a 2030 call date. We have an Overweight recommendation on the older bonds, and with the additional spread reasonable in our view, we initiate with an Overweight recommendation the 2036 / '31 bond. A z-spread in the low 100s is supported by strong credit ratings of A2 / BBB+ / A by Moody's / S&P / Fitch. More generally, we think Singapore bank sub-bonds look cheap compared to senior bonds issued by Indian banks, which trade at tighter spreads despite the significant ratings differential. We expect disciplined capital management at OCBCSP to continue, but a more aggressive approach, potentially through larger acquisitions, could pose a downside risk.

ROE increased 1.4% pts q/q to 13%, with net profit rising 13% q/q, supported by record non-interest income that offset a decline in net interest income amid a lower rate environment. Net interest income declined 3% q/q to S\$2.2 billion, weighed down by lower interest rates and partly offset by a decline in deposit costs and loan growth. Net interest margin compressed to 1.76%, down 10bp q/q, reflecting lower asset yields and strategic growth in high-quality assets. Non-interest income increased 22% q/q to S\$1.6 billion, driven by 12% growth in fee income, a 10% increase in trading revenues and an 81% rise in insurance income on the back of previously reported results at Great Eastern. Loan growth was broad-based, up 2% q/q to S\$347 billion, led by Singapore, Malaysia, and international markets. Asset quality remained resilient, with the NPL ratio holding steady at 0.9% for eight consecutive quarters. Total NPA coverage rose to 163%, up 12% pts q/q. Total allowances increased 8% q/q to S\$216 million, mostly comprising allowances for non-impaired assets of S\$191 million, reflecting management overlays for higher macro risks. Management highlighted disciplined strategic investments, including the acquisition of HSBC's wealth business in Indonesia, and noted the group's strong capital, funding, and liquidity position as key to navigating ongoing macro uncertainties. Common equity Tier 1 ratio was 15.2%, up 10bp q/q, while the total capital ratio improved by 30bp q/q to 19.7%. (Matt / Emma)

Zhongsheng - Narrowing price discounts and increasing EV penetration positive to earnings recovery

The China Association of Automobile Manufacturers (CAAM) released April auto sales data yesterday. While domestic sales of passenger vehicles (PV) were still weak a 20% m/m drop in April due to cautious consumer sentiment, we see two bright spots from the data release. **First**, elevated oil prices continue to accelerate EV adoption. EV PV retail penetration surpassed the 60% milestone in April. **Second**, pricing discounts for car sales have narrowed. Overall market pricing continued its gradual recovery, with discounts down to 16.3% in 2H April from 17.3% in 2H March, marking the third consecutive bi-monthly improvement since the record-high discount recorded in 2H February. Please see J.P. Morgan China Auto research team's [report](#) for more details.

We view these developments as positive for Zhongsheng (ZS). The company has been trying to narrow losses from new car sales through (1) network optimization, (2) product mix

improvement (mix shift towards EVs which generate higher margins), and (3) leveraging Benz's upcoming powerful model cycle. We expect its earnings will turn around from 2026E after multiple years of decline, on the back of (1) narrower losses from new car sales, (2) steady expansion of high-margin after-sale service, and (3) absence of asset impairment. We forecast its net gearing (adjusted for impairment) will decrease from 3.8x in 2025 to 2.1x/1.6x by 2026E/27E alongside earnings recovery, and we believe ZS will be able to maintain an IG rating. We are OW on the '28s (97.8 offer, 7.4% ytw, z+354), as we appreciate its attractive >7% yield for a BBB- credit, with potential further compression upon earnings/credit quality recovery. Please see our recent [initiation report](#) for details. (*Alvin*)

UPL Corp – Solid FY26 results

UPL Ltd. (UPL) reported strong FY26 results yesterday. On the consolidated level, EBITDA increased by 18% y/y to Rs96bn on the back of an 11% y/y increase in revenue to Rs518bn. For 4QFY26, EBITDA was up by 13% y/y to Rs36bn. The 11% y/y increase in FY26 revenue was led by higher volumes (+8%) and INR depreciation (+6%), which offset the impact of lower prices (-3%). The company generated Rs55bn of OCF, post interest expense of Rs34bn and ~Rs12bn of working capital requirements. After ~Rs24bn of capex, UPL generated ~Rs31bn of FCF in FY26. On the balance sheet, total debt levels decreased by 11% y/y to Rs236bn while cash balances decreased to Rs66bn from Rs99bn last year. This translates into a reduction in net leverage to 1.8x from 2.1x in FY25. Including non-recourse factoring of ~Rs102bn, adjusted net leverage came in at 2.8x, down from 3.2x in the same period last year.

Recovery was broad-based with EBITDA expansion across verticals and geographies. The global crop protection business (UPL Corp) reported a 20% y/y increase in EBITDA to Rs60bn. India crop protection (UPL SAS) reported a 24% y/y increase to Rs5.5bn. The seeds business (Advanta) reported a 30% y/y increase in EBITDA to Rs17bn while SUPERFORM reported a 10% y/y increase to Rs13bn. For UPL Corp, volume growth of 7% and FX impact of 7% offset the 3% decline in prices. It is important to note that the INR depreciation has amplified UPL's reported topline numbers. On a USD-basis, EBITDA increased by 6% y/y to US\$1.01bn on flattish revenues of US\$5.5bn in FY26. The company is guiding for a 10-14% increase in revenue for 1QFY27, out of which 7-9% growth is attributed to the impact of INR depreciation, according to the company's earnings call. EBITDA growth of 14-18% is expected in the same period, with a similar 7-9% FX impact.

We view the results as credit positive for UPL. So far, the company has been able to navigate the impact of the Middle-East conflict, though management thinks that the situation remains uncertain. We will continue to monitor the impact of input cost increases and the company's ability to pass on these increases to end-consumers over the coming quarters. Nevertheless, we think that the optimistic guidance for the coming quarter should alleviate some concerns about supply chain disruptions for now. (*Aman*)

Table 1: J.P. Morgan Asia Credit Index Performance

As at 11 May 2026

Index	Return, %				SOT to Worst, bp					YTW, bp & %					Dur.	Mkt Cap (US\$bn)	% of Index
	1D	1W	1M	YTD	1D	1W	1M	YTD	Cur	1D	1W	1M	YTD	Cur	Cur		
JACI	0.0%	0.4%	0.5%	0.8%	0	-5	-11	-2	84	1	-5	0	25	5.2%	4.5	890	100%
JACI IG	0.0%	0.3%	0.4%	0.5%	0	-4	-10	0	62	1	-5	1	26	5.0%	4.7	774	87%
JACI HY	0.1%	0.6%	0.9%	2.7%	-2	-11	-27	-28	314	-1	-11	-14	4	7.4%	2.9	116	13%
JACI APAC	0.0%	0.3%	0.4%	0.7%	0	-3	-9	-3	110	0	-4	2	25	5.2%	5.0	1,467	100%
JACI APAC IG	0.0%	0.3%	0.3%	0.5%	0	-3	-8	-1	84	1	-4	3	27	5.0%	5.0	1,305	89%
JACI APAC HY	0.1%	0.5%	0.8%	2.4%	-1	-6	-19	-17	310	-1	-10	-14	5	7.1%	5.2	162	11%
Segmental																	
Sovereign	0.0%	0.4%	0.4%	0.1%	0	-4	-10	3	72	1	-5	0	26	5.3%	6.6	170	19%
Quasi-sov	-0.1%	0.3%	0.3%	0.5%	1	-3	-9	0	54	1	-4	2	25	5.0%	4.6	202	23%
Financial	0.0%	0.3%	0.5%	1.1%	0	-7	-14	-11	84	0	-7	0	23	5.0%	2.9	246	28%
IG Corp (exfin)	0.0%	0.4%	0.4%	0.6%	1	-4	-11	-3	64	1	-5	1	22	5.1%	5.1	205	23%
HY Corp (exfin)	0.1%	0.6%	0.8%	2.8%	-2	-7	-31	-27	377	-1	-7	-18	4	8.0%	2.8	67	8%
EM comparables																	
CEMBI Broad	-0.1%	0.3%	0.8%	1.4%	-2	-2	-16	-10	153	3	-4	-6	19	5.9%	4.3	1,185	100%
IG	-0.1%	0.3%	0.5%	0.4%	-2	-1	-12	-8	91	3	-4	-2	20	5.3%	4.8	781	66%
HY	0.0%	0.3%	1.4%	3.3%	-3	-2	-26	-19	325	2	-4	-16	12	7.5%	3.3	404	34%
Asia	-0.1%	0.4%	0.5%	1.2%	-2	-5	-12	-10	103	3	-7	-2	20	5.4%	3.7	509	43%
Asia IG	-0.1%	0.3%	0.4%	0.9%	-1	-4	-10	-10	67	3	-6	1	20	5.0%	4.0	414	35%
Asia HY	0.1%	0.6%	0.9%	2.7%	-5	-8	-22	-18	330	0	-10	-10	17	7.5%	2.5	96	8%
LATAM	-0.1%	0.3%	1.3%	2.1%	-3	-1	-21	-22	211	2	-3	-10	5	6.5%	5.1	314	26%
LATAM IG	-0.1%	0.3%	0.7%	-0.5%	-2	0	-12	-23	115	2	-3	-1	2	5.7%	6.8	132	11%
LATAM HY	-0.1%	0.2%	1.7%	4.1%	-3	-1	-30	-35	329	2	-3	-19	-2	7.6%	3.9	182	15%
CEEMEA	-0.1%	0.2%	0.9%	1.1%	-2	1	-17	2	155	3	-2	-8	29	5.9%	4.4	362	31%
CEEMEA IG	-0.1%	0.1%	0.7%	0.2%	-2	2	-15	6	107	2	-1	-5	33	5.5%	5.2	236	20%
CEEMEA HY	0.0%	0.3%	1.4%	2.7%	0	1	-22	8	313	4	-2	-16	34	7.2%	2.9	127	11%
EMBIG	-0.1%	0.7%	1.1%	2.0%	-2	-4	-13	2	181	2	-7	-4	25	6.4%	6.4	1,407	100%
EMBIG IG	-0.2%	0.4%	0.5%	0.4%	-1	-1	-8	2	95	3	-4	1	25	5.6%	7.1	795	56%
EMBIG HY	0.0%	1.0%	2.0%	4.3%	-3	-11	-23	-2	325	1	-14	-14	21	7.7%	5.5	612	44%
Market breakdown																	
China	0.0%	0.3%	0.3%	0.8%	0	-5	-11	-2	64	1	-5	1	26	5.0%	3.7	236	27%
Hong Kong	0.0%	0.3%	0.4%	1.1%	0	-3	-10	-3	99	1	-4	1	25	5.4%	4.7	141	16%
Korea	0.0%	0.2%	0.2%	0.8%	1	-4	-6	-7	45	2	-4	8	27	4.5%	2.8	140	16%
India	0.0%	0.5%	0.8%	1.6%	1	-10	-21	-24	116	2	-10	-9	10	5.4%	3.5	56	6%
Indonesia	0.0%	0.5%	0.8%	-0.2%	0	-4	-13	8	91	0	-5	-4	29	5.5%	6.9	121	14%
Macao	0.0%	0.3%	0.6%	1.2%	-1	-6	-19	4	174	0	-6	-5	41	5.7%	2.3	22	2%
Philippines	0.0%	0.3%	0.5%	-0.4%	0	-1	-10	7	92	1	-3	0	32	5.4%	6.6	56	6%
Thailand	0.0%	0.5%	0.9%	0.9%	0	-8	-20	-4	109	1	-9	-8	16	5.5%	4.7	20	2%
Taiwan	-0.1%	0.5%	0.4%	0.7%	1	-6	-7	-3	49	1	-7	3	23	4.9%	6.0	16	2%
Malaysia	-0.1%	0.5%	0.7%	0.9%	1	-4	-3	2	62	1	-6	5	23	5.3%	7.2	28	3%
Singapore	-0.1%	0.2%	0.1%	0.4%	1	-3	-5	0	38	2	-3	7	28	4.7%	4.0	34	4%
Pakistan	0.0%	0.7%	0.7%	2.0%	-1	-12	-14	-9	369	0	-12	-2	20	8.0%	3.5	7	1%
Sri Lanka	0.4%	1.8%	1.1%	6.2%	-7	-25	-19	-90	199	-6	-26	-7	-63	6.3%	5.9	8	1%

Source: J.P. Morgan.

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OCBC Bank - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	09 May 24	Withdrawn	Not Rated	OCBCSP
Issuer	06 Aug 25	Restored	Overweight	OCBCSP
5.52% 2034 / '29c *	14 Jul 24	Withdrawn	Not Rated	XS2823260604
5.52% 2034 / '29c *	06 Aug 25	Restored	Overweight	XS2823260604
1.625% '15	29 Apr 15	Terminate	Not Covered	USY64248GW41
1.832% '30 c25	09 May 24	Withdrawn	Not Rated	US69033CAD11
1.832% '30 c25	11 Sep 25	—	Not Covered	US69033CAD11
3.150% '18c	15 Feb 18	Terminate	Not Covered	US69033DAA54
3.75% '17c	16 Nov 17	Terminate	Not Covered	XS0558774161
4.0% 24/19c	05 Nov 19	Terminate	Not Covered	US69033DAB38
4.25% '18c	11 Feb 15	Terminate	Not Covered	—
4.25% '24	09 May 24	Withdrawn	Not Rated	US69033DAC11
4.25% '24	11 Sep 25	—	Not Covered	US69033DAC11
4.55% 2035 / '30c	11 Sep 25	Initiate	Overweight	US69033DAE76
4.602% '32	09 May 24	Withdrawn	Not Rated	XS2490811168
4.602% '32	06 Aug 25	Restored	Overweight	XS2490811168
WINHAN 6% ' 17 Perp	25 Aug 16	—	Not Covered	XS0296645012

UPL - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	17 May 24	Initiate	Neutral	UPLLIN
Issuer	08 Aug 24	Upgrade	Overweight	UPLLIN
Issuer	24 Sep 24	Downgrade	Neutral	UPLLIN
Issuer	12 Nov 24	Upgrade	Overweight	UPLLIN
Issuer	03 Feb 26	Downgrade	Neutral	UPLLIN
4.625% 2030 *	17 May 24	Initiate	Neutral	XS2189565992
4.625% 2030 *	08 Aug 24	Upgrade	Overweight	XS2189565992
4.625% 2030 *	24 Sep 24	Downgrade	Neutral	XS2189565992
4.625% 2030 *	12 Nov 24	Upgrade	Overweight	XS2189565992
4.625% 2030 *	03 Feb 26	Downgrade	Neutral	XS2189565992
4.5% 2028	17 May 24	Initiate	Neutral	XS1789391148
4.5% 2028	08 Aug 24	Upgrade	Overweight	XS1789391148
4.5% 2028	24 Sep 24	Downgrade	Neutral	XS1789391148
4.5% 2028	12 Nov 24	Upgrade	Overweight	XS1789391148
4.5% 2028	06 Nov 25	Downgrade	Neutral	XS1789391148
5.25% c 2/25 Perp	17 May 24	Initiate	Underweight	XS2125139464
5.25% c 2/25 Perp	12 Nov 24	Upgrade	Overweight	XS2125139464
5.25% c 2/25 Perp	11 Sep 25	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2125139464

Zhongsheng Group Holdings - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	19 Apr 26	Initiate	Overweight	ZHOSHK
5.98% '28 *	19 Apr 26	Initiate	Overweight	XS2867272630

***Indicates representative/primary bond/instrument.**

The table(s) above show the recommendation changes made by J.P. Morgan Credit Research Analysts in the subject company and/or instruments over the past three years (or, if no recommendation changes were made during that period, the most recent change). Notes: Effective April 11, 2016, J.P. Morgan changed its Credit Research Ratings System. Please see the Explanation of Credit Research Ratings below for the new definitions. The previous rating system no longer should be relied upon. For the history prior to April 11, 2016, please call 1-800-447-0406 or e-mail research.disclosure.inquiries@jpmorgan.com.

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Valuation & Methodology: For J.P. Morgan's Emerging Markets Sovereign Research, we assign a rating to each sovereign issuer (Overweight, Marketweight or Underweight) based on our view of whether the combination of the issuer's fundamentals, market technicals, and the relative value of its securities will cause it to outperform, perform in line with, or underperform the credit returns of the EMBIG index over the next three months. Our view of an issuer's fundamentals includes our opinion of whether the issuer is becoming more or less able to service its debt obligations when they become due and payable, as well as whether its willingness to service debt obligations is increasing or decreasing.

J.P. Morgan Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Ratings Distribution, as of April 4, 2026

	Overweight (buy)	Marketweight (hold)	Underweight (sell)
Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Universe*	6%	84%	10%
IB clients**	100%	86%	100%

*Please note that the percentages may not add to 100% because of rounding.

**Percentage of subject issuers within each of the "Overweight," "Marketweight" and "Underweight" categories for which J.P. Morgan has provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

For purposes of FINRA ratings distribution rules only, our Overweight rating falls into a buy rating category; our Marketweight rating falls into a hold rating category; and our Underweight rating falls into a sell rating category. The Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Rating Distribution is at the issuer level. Issuers with an NR or an NC designation are not included in the table above. This information is current as of the end of the most recent calendar quarter.

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J.P. Morgan Credit Research Ratings Distribution, as of April 04, 2026

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Global Credit Research Universe*	27%	57%	16%
IB clients**	84%	84%	89%

*Please note that the percentages may not add to 100% because of rounding.

**Percentage of subject companies within each of the "Overweight," "Neutral" and "Underweight" categories for which J.P. Morgan has provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

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